

When the creation is complete, the character needs to obtain it. The Glamour within it isn't released until the creation is destroyed. As such, a changeling can conceivably acquire a library's or museum's worth of Glamour-filled creations, just waiting to be burned for power. When the creation is destroyed, all changelings present split the released Glamour among them. Note that since only the changelings *present* reap the benefits of the Rhapsody, it is quite possible for a changeling to convince others to assist him in beginning the process, and then steal the result to get the Glamour all to himself. This is a highly dishonorable thing to do, but to whom are the aggrieved parties going to complain? Rhapsody is forbidden, anyway.

If the roll fails, the artist never finishes the creation. Pumping further Glamour into her simply confuses her; she is unable to create (or rather, finish creating anything) for a number of months equal to the invested Glamour.

If the roll is a botch, the changelings get their comeuppance in a terrible way, but the artist suffers as well. For every 1 rolled on the botch, the creator gains a dot of Banality. No one gains any Glamour. This means the changeling faces the possibility of not only *losing* Glamour, but that the artist may become too entrenched in Banality to remain connected to the Dreaming. Again, the Dreamer can never create again and the changelings have destroyed the mortal's gift for nothing.

Oaths

Oaths, promises sworn among changelings and backed with the power of Glamour, form the pillars of the semi-feudal structure of changeling society. From the oaths made between liege and vassal (common in mortal history during the Middle Ages) to oaths reflecting personal codes of honor, such as those often sworn by trolls, oaths serve to strengthen the fabric of changeling society by weaving together those who swear the oaths. In addition, the oaths themselves give tangible substance, in the form of threads of Glamour, to the ideas they uphold.

Oaths create a network of ties among Kithain. Both Seelie and Unseelie changelings take their oaths seriously. Indeed, breaking an oath and becoming forsworn stands as one of the greatest social crimes for members of either Court.

Whether oaths bind a group of changelings to their feudal lord, two fast friends to one another, or a small group of changelings into an oathcircle, the bonds they form stand as sacred and inviolable. Judgment, and often swift punishment, usually follow those who break an oath, and the term *oath breaker* sentences its bearer to a dark future among fellow changelings. Often those who break faith with an oath find themselves shut out from the society of other changelings.

Occasionally, a changeling must seem to break an oath in order to keep it, something which touches upon the difference between the letter and the spirit of the oath in question. For example, when a changeling vassal disobeys the order of a lord who has become ensorcelled, insane, or placed under duress, the vassal's disobedience may, in fact, keep the spirit of his oath intact. In these cases, society may condemn the changeling, but often the Dreaming itself justifies and supports

the individual who has honored the meaning, rather than the wording, of the oath.

Swearing an Oath

While the act of swearing an oath may involve complex ceremonies (such as elaborate marriage or betrothal rituals) or simple statements (such as a strong promise from one changeling to another), the structure of the oath itself involves only a few steps.

- ☉ The members involved in the oath taking must gather in one place.
- ☉ The oath takers must craft and use the exact working of the oath and speak the appropriate words.
- ☉ Either the taker of the oath, the oath's holder, or all those involved must call upon the Dreaming and invest at least one point of Glamour to activate the binding nature of the oath.

How to Build an Oath

Most oaths have come down from the days before the Sundering and have survived, with few changes, both during the Interregnum and after the Resurgence. In many cases, the language became more modern, though always hinting at its original formality. In recent years, modern changelings have experimented with formulating their own oaths to reflect individual personalities and circumstances, much like a couple writing their own wedding vows. So long as the revisions meet the following guidelines, the Dreaming honors the oath and Glamour binds the oath takers.

- ☉ State the essential character of the oath. "I swear my loyalty to you," or "I promise to undertake the following," outlines the parameters of the oath.
- ☉ Any qualifications to the oath must appear in the words of the oath. "I swear my loyalty to you, unless prevented by ties of blood," allows the oath taker some leeway when faced with conflicting family ties. If these caveats do not appear, then the oath taker must hew to the wording of the oath. Wise or crafty oath makers sometimes take these qualifications to an extreme, but if the "do's" and "don'ts" entailed within the oath prove too cumbersome, the oath simply fails to work and must be reformulated before it is used again.
- ☉ Images from the natural world lend strength to an oath. In this way, the power of nature itself lends strength by association. "As a tree roots itself in the earth," "as the moon rules the tides," and "as the sun's light warms all it touches," are examples of using natural comparisons to build an oath, giving it imaginative and visual substance in the minds of those taking it.
- ☉ The rule of three, or threefold statements, add to the power of the oath. Drawing from many traditions, some of them ancient, and others based on superstition, repeating something three times or saying something in three ways reinforces the oath's hold on its takers. "By the sun, the moon, and all the stars," or "as the tree needs water, as the flowers need sun, and as the child needs love," show how this rule of three adds portent to anything that follows.